

Naval Authorities Expect Under Sea Fleet to Strike In U. S. Waters In Six Days

WASHINGTON, March 12.—The U-boats are coming! Within six days, at least, in the opinion of naval authorities in Washington, German submarines will appear off the Atlantic coast and in the Gulf of Mexico, ready to pounce upon the shipping that attempts to leave American ports.

This is the explanation given for the sudden cessation of the sinking of merchant vessels during the last week. It is pointed out that the last reported activities of the submarines occurred on February 26, the day on which President Wilson made his armed neutrality declaration. According to this view, as soon as the president announced his intention of using armed force, the submarines were notified by wireless to proceed to their stations in American waters, which had been assigned before they were sent to sea.

A Mysterious Disappearance

Two Men and Two Wagons Lost on the Plains

By ETHEL HOLMES

One of the many men who, when gold had been discovered in California, started out to gather in the precious metal was Elmer Winston. But Winston went out under different conditions from most of the gold seekers. His partner in business, George Hunter, had gone before him, purchased a piece of property on which there was evidence of gold, had returned, and the two, having got together mining machinery and other articles necessary to their purpose, started from Council Bluffs with two wagons to make the trip over the plains and the mountains to California.

The Golden State was in those days very remote. It was a long journey either by land or sea, and there were dangers which induced both Winston and Hunter to leave papers with their families to designate the location of the property they were going to develop. Not that there was any certainty of its being valuable—indeed, very few of the claims proved to be so—but common prudence dictated this course.

The partners, having crossed the Missouri, followed the Platte river. They had traversed about half the distance to the mountains when they met a train of empty wagons returning from Denver, by which they sent letters to their families, stating that they were both well and all was proceeding satisfactorily with them.

These letters contained the last information that was received from them. It was assumed that they would have opportunity at least once in a week or two to send back a communication to their homes, and when a month had passed and no word had come from them it was feared that something had happened.

The main danger was from Indians, and those interested in them began to dread lest they should hear of the two men having come to grief in this way. But no such news was ever received, nor was there any report of mishap to them of any other kind. When sufficient time had elapsed for them to reach the Golden State and send letters home by sea and still no news came from them, their families and friends and neighbors made a pool for the purpose of sending some one to learn the truth concerning them.

Edward Jenkins, a nephew of Hunter's, was selected to make the search. Going to Council Bluffs, he attached himself to a wagon train about to go

over the same route as the partners and made inquiries along the way to the point where they were last seen. This was at a settlement, or rather, a station on the bank of the north fork of the Platte river. At this place Jenkins was informed that on or about the date that Winston and Hunter should have been in that location a couple of men, with two wagons, had left the station one morning to go westward. Several days later some Indians had come in and reported having met them. The two wagons were a quarter of a mile apart. Night was coming on.

This was the last information Jenkins was able to secure of the two men. He went over the route they were supposed to have taken, but beyond the spot where the Indians had seen them no trace of them whatever could be found. It was as if they had been spirited away from the earth.

Jenkins made inquiries if there had been hostile Indians in the neighborhood at the time of the disappearance, but was told that none such were reported. Besides, if the travelers had been killed by Indians not only the wagons and machinery, but their bodies, would have been found. The redskins would have no use for anything except the horses and stores of provisions.

Jenkins could not be certain of the exact ground the partners had gone over, though he knew the route. There were no actual roads, or wherever there was a road it was a mere track, and there were a number of them leading in the same direction.

Having gained evidence to show that those he sought had not been killed by Indians, that they had not sickened and died on the journey, that they had not been destroyed by storm or flood, Jenkins returned to the east and reported the result of his labors. Had he told that the two men were dead it would have ended the matter. As it was, suspense took possession of their families and curiosity of their friends.

Mrs. Winston and Mrs. Hunter after consultation with advisers decided to do nothing more in the matter. They had no deeds to the property, no means for its development and no one to intrust with the matter. Besides they had had quite enough of gold seeking in the disappearance of their husbands.

A daughter was born to Winston after he left for California. When she became old enough to hear about the father who had mysteriously disappeared she wondered a great deal about him—how he could have died, whether he had died. She was given to conjuring up scenes in which he returned to his home. When Alice Winston had grown to be seventeen years old Horace Fleetwood, a young man whose father was quite well off, fell in love with her. Alice reciprocated, but the

affairs of the Winston family after the father's leaving for California had steadily deteriorated, and Alice had no dowry. Young Fleetwood being dependent on his father and that father forbidding a match for his son with a poor girl, the prospect before the lovers was not encouraging.

Horace Fleetwood knew the story of Alice's father's disappearance and

SPRING BRINGS NEW ACTIVITY IN EUROPEAN WAR CAMPAIGNS



BRIDGE BUILDING ON THE SALONIKI FRONT

Spring is coming to the battlefields of Europe and, the peace talk having proved barren of results, preparations for renewed and greater fighting are being made on all fronts. One such preparation, made by the British

learned that certain property supposed to contain gold had been inherited by the Winston and Hunter families. Alice still clung to the theory that the father might return some day to the child he had never seen, and it troubled her. Horace, in order to settle her suspense, conceived the idea of going to California to kill two birds with one stone. He would look up the mining property of Winston & Hunter and on the way would try to find out something about their disappearance.

Naturally the heirs of the partners favored the idea. Fleetwood, without informing his father of his real object, gained his consent to the trip and was furnished with means for his expenses. Taking papers giving the location of the property he was to investigate, he set out over the same route the partners had taken some seventeen or eighteen years before. But by this time the Union Pacific railroad was under construction and had been completed as far west as Laramie. The traveler went by rail to that point and the rest of the way by coach.

He stopped in the region where the two men had disappeared long enough to make inquiries; but, nearly two decades having passed since the disappearance, he did not get even as much information as Jenkins had obtained. He went on, hoping for better luck in the matter of the mining property. Should this prove to be worth something he proposed to stop on his way back and make a strenuous effort to learn the fate of the father of the girl he loved.

On reaching San Francisco Fleetwood learned where the property was located and proceeded to its inspection. He found that it adjoined one of the most productive mines in California. The vein this company worked led into the Winston & Hunter property, which made the prospective value of the latter very considerable. Fleetwood called upon the president of the adjoining mine and learned that they had been desirous for years to buy the Winston and Hunter property, but had not been able to find to whom it belonged. He offered to take the owners of the property into his company, giving them a block of stock in payment, provided the heirs could convey it, giving a clear title.

But it was evident that the heirs could not give a clear title. Not only had the deed disappeared with the original owners, but it was not known if they were dead. If they lived they and not their heirs were the persons to convey the property.

Fleetwood was much chagrined to see a fortune in which the girl he loved had sufficient interest to make her rich kept from its rightful owners. He could do nothing but return home and report what would be extremely tantalizing. Leaving California, he crossed the mountains and proceeded over the plains by coach so far as the railroad had been finished. There he changed from coach to car.

While making the change he learned that the railroad under construction had struck a quicksand.

Now, a quicksand is not a good foundation for a railroad. A gang of men was set to work to get the sand out of the way, that a solid bottom might be obtained. The space occupied by the sand was quite deep. They had gone down a few feet when they came to a man's hat. A little farther down they took out a man's body. The next thing they came to was a wagon, and before the wagon was a pair of horses harnessed to it. Beneath the horses were another man and a wagon and in front of the wagon another pair of horses.

Fleetwood at once accepted this as the true solution of the mystery. The two men, with their outfit, had been engulfed in the quicksand, and, since the top of a quicksand gives no more elev than water as to what is beneath, the discovery of what had become of the men was impossible. Had the location of the railroad not been straight across the burial place the mystery would never have been solved.

Fleetwood at once learned where that which had been exhumed had been taken and on going there found what had so long been missing. In a pocket of the clothing on Winston was found a leather wallet, in which were papers identifying him, together with a deed for the property he had been going west to develop when engulfed. On arriving at home Fleetwood called together the Winston and Hunter families and made his report. He was

disappointed to return to California, stop on the way to make proper disposition of the exhumed property and the bodies and on arriving at his destination accept the offer to add the property to the adjoining mine. He returned at once, completed both tasks and brought home with him certificates of stock that yielded an ample income for all concerned.

After the finding of the lost wagons how the loss had occurred was made somewhat clearer. The wagons for some unexplained reason had become separated. Night had come on when the first wagon struck the quicksand, and if the man driving it had time to cry out how near he came to shooting the hindmost came up, his partner being engulfed, there was nothing to warn him.

Alice Winston's share of the property was larger than Fleetwood senior's fortune. Consequently there was no objection on the part of the Fleetwood family to a marriage between young Fleetwood and Alice.

LONG EAGLE FLIGHT.

Tagged in Montana, It Was Killed Near Bogota, Colombia.

El Centro, Mont.—P. R. Christian of Route No. 1, box 62, El Centro, while in Choteau, Mont., Aug. 19, caught a golden eagle in his wheat field.

He released the bird the next day with a small bottle containing his name and address tied to its leg.

Mr. Christian recently received a message from Luis Felipe Ruidia, in the Republic of Colombia, stating that Ruidia killed the eagle Oct. 29, 1916. The eagle flew 3,700 miles from Montana to the plains north of Bogota.

When the bird was captured Mr. Christian planned to keep it as a pet, but it evinced such a desire to get away that he decided to mark it in some manner so as to determine its habits. Mr. Christian said that the bird was on its way south when it landed in his field exhausted.

MUST OBEY WIFE FOR YEAR.

Must Also Take Pledge, Is Ruling of a Cincinnati Judge.

Cincinnati.—For one year Alfred Almsworth of 912 Livingston street must obey his wife's commands or serve a suspended sentence of three months in the workhouse. In addition he must at his wife's command sign the pledge. This is the decision of Judge Fox, rendered in the municipal court, after the wife had preferred charges of assault and battery.

"If he refuses to obey you just report to me," Judge Fox sententially remarked to Mrs. Almsworth. Almsworth wearily followed when his wife said "let's go home."

substitution. Did you know something just as Philadelphia Ledger.

WILL YOU HAVE A TURN UP OR A TURN DOWN BRIM?



Two Knockouts.

JOLLY NERVOUS, WHAT? BAGGAGE CHAP, TOO! NOT DONE, AT ALL!

LONDON, March 12.—W. S. Webber, a baggage master at the Lea Bridge station of the important Great Eastern railway, has given the conservative British Public a shock by announcing his candidacy for a seat on the railroad's board of directors. He is himself a small stockholder.

Little Ether Waves Spoil Neat Plan to Nab Liquor Lugger

PORTLAND, Ore., March 12.—District Attorney Evans learned Monday that the wireless message which warned officers on the "boozie ship" Breakwater that the vessel was to be searched for liquor was sent into the air at Astoria.

"Probably," he commented, "after some member of the bootleggers' ring in Portland had tipped it off to another member in Astoria by long-distance telephone."

FUNSTON'S ESCAPE

Narrowly Missed Being Shot by General Fitzhugh Lee.

LEE DIDN'T RECOGNIZE HIM.

Captor of Aguinaldo Had Long Hair, Unkempt Beard and Gaunt Appearance and Approached Lee Cautiously. Got Aboard Steamer Next Day Without Arousing Suspicion.

Washington.—There are many stories told here of Major General Fred Funston, whose death occurred recently. One of the stories has to do with General Fitzhugh Lee, now dead, of whom the intrepid captor of Aguinaldo, the Filipino chief.

Just before the Maine was blown up General Lee received many threats that he would be killed and was in daily fear of his life. Soon after being warned of a plot to slay him the American consul general at Havana got one of the worst scares in his life.

He was alone in his office when the door opened and one of the worst looking faces he had ever seen looked in at him. The man had long hair, unkempt beard and a gaunt appearance. His hat was full of holes, his shoes about all gone, and he had no clothing apparently but a linen duster. He approached General Lee cautiously, and the latter instinctively grasped his revolver. "If that fellow had once put his hand under his duster I am positive I would have shot him without waiting for a word," said General Lee.

"I was satisfied he had been hired to come and kill me. When he approached me by asking in good English if I was General Lee, I told him I was and asked him who he was. He said he belonged to the Cuban army, was General Gomez's chief of artillery and wanted to go back to the United States."

"He said he was from Kansas and had enough of the Cubans. I told him he was taking his life in his hands by coming into the Spanish lines and if he was caught they would make quick work of him as a spy."

"He said he didn't care. I was satisfied he was telling the truth and sent him out for a bath and hair cut. When he came back in a new suit of clothes you wouldn't have recognized him as the same man. I got him aboard a steamer the next day without arousing any suspicion. He landed safely in the United States. That man was General Funston, who captured Aguinaldo."

INTERSTATE BRIDGE OPENED.

\$1,750,000 Structure Between Washington and Oregon In Use.

Vancouver, Wash.—In a din of steam-whistles, clanging bells and cheers from thousands of spectators the new \$1,750,000 interstate bridge between Oregon and Washington was opened.

The structure is one of the longest in the world, four miles, including approaches. It spans the Columbia river between Vancouver and Multnomah counties a few miles from Portland. When the great central draw was lowered into place a street car crowded with officials and noted visitors crossed slowly. That was the signal for an outburst of noise such as the old Columbia river never heard before. A procession of flag-bedecked automobiles followed the car, and another long line of machines started at the same time from the Washington side. They passed in the middle.

SHE BRAVES U BOATS.

Undaunted by Submarine Menace, Miss Floretta Sails to Meet Lover.

Philadelphia.—Believing that woman's place is in the home, after all, Miss Nellie Floretta of Liverpool has given up her job in an English munitions factory to marry a Clifton Heights shoemaker.

Hereafter Miss Floretta's pretty hands will make bread instead of bullets. She became the bride of Samuel Kooyoomjian, an Armenian shoemaker, employed in a shop at Clifton Heights, thus ending—perhaps beginning—a romance that had its origin five years ago when Kooyoomjian deserted the Turkish army and made his way to Liverpool.

Undaunted by the Kaiser's submarine warfare, Miss Floretta, twenty-three years old, pretty and blond, left Liverpool, landing in New York on the steamer Kronland.

GERARD AND PARTY ARE SAFE IN WASHINGTON AFTER 7000 MILE JOURNEY FROM BERLIN

WASHINGTON, March 14.—Ambassador Gerard reached the end of his 7000-mile journey from Berlin to Washington at 1:15 this afternoon. Gerard and his party were met at the station here by a large crowd of cheering spectators, friends, relations and government officials and newspaper men.

Gerard was in happy spirits, as was every member of his party. He and Mrs. Gerard gaily waved their hands at the throngs, bowed at the enflaming movie machine men and joined in the cheering.

Immediately upon arrival Gerard was given a memorandum from the White House, suggesting that he continue to make no comment whatever on the German situation until after he had transmitted his full report to the state department and President Wilson.

Gerard was as closely guarded as the president when he alighted from the train at Union station, a large number of secret service operatives being on hand to accompany him during his stay in Washington.

FIVE CAUGHT IN LAND FRAUD NET BY U. S. AGENTS

PORTLAND, Ore., March 8.—After waiting almost two years, action was obtained yesterday on a secret indictment returned in June, 1915, by the federal grand jury against an alleged ring of fraudulent locators of lands in the original Oregon & California land grant. Simultaneously in several parts of the west yesterday five of the six men were arrested for using the mails to defraud, and will be brought to Portland immediately for trial.

The men arrested were W. F. Halliwell and George L. Young, arrested in Seattle by Special Agent Byron; W. J. Earl, arrested in San Francisco; Gottlieb Miller, arrested in Portland in the Multnomah poolroom in the Broadway building, and W. F. Lick, arrested in Montana.

German Sailors Get One Year and \$500 For Disabling Ship

FLORENCE, S. C., March 10.—The eight under officers of the German freighter Liebenfels were today sentenced to one year in the federal prison at Atlanta and \$500 fine each on the charge of having sunk their vessel in the Charleston harbor when diplomatic relations were broken with Germany. Notice of appeal was given.

Cashier Planned His Disappearance, Say Portland Detectives

PORTLAND, Ore., March 12.—That the disappearance of O. Buxton, missing cashier of the First National bank of Forest Grove, was planned several weeks ahead by Buxton was the belief held Saturday by detectives who are working on the case.

COSSACKS CHARGE HUNGRY MOBS IN RUSSIAN CAPITAL

STOCKHOLM, March 12.—Serious food riots, coupled with peace demonstrations, have occurred in both Petrograd and Moscow.

Cossacks charged a wild mob that formed in the Russian capital Thursday night and wrecked bakers' shops and in the melee a number of persons were injured. For more than an hour the mob was in control of large sections of the city.

PORTLAND PEOPLE SEE LIGHT

Multnomah county is the heart of Oregon—Portland the heart of Multnomah. Three-eighths the total assessed valuation of the state is in Multnomah. Three-eighths of the present state wide tax for state roads comes from Portland and over one-third of the people of the state reside in Multnomah county, nearer one-half, in fact, making it easily possible for that same proportion of the owners of automobiles to be residents of that county.

At the present time, the automobile license is refunded by the state treasurer to the different counties of the state after the costs of administration are paid. This gave to Multnomah county each year \$30,000 or \$40,000—to be spent upon the roads of Multnomah county.

Under the new bond law to be voted upon by the people of Oregon on June 4th, Multnomah county will not get one cent from the state for roads, and the moneys heretofore returned to Multnomah county will be spent for interest on the proposed bonds.

Besides this, with three-eighths of the assessed valuation of the state, Multnomah taxpayers will continue to pay three-eighths of the road tax, or

SHIPS ARE ARMED; SPECIAL SESSION CALLED BY WILSON

WASHINGTON, March 9.—President Wilson today called an extra session of congress in April and also decided that he had power to arm American merchantmen against German submarines operating in violation of international law.

The president is expected to exercise his authority to arm American merchantmen forthwith.

The extra session of congress was set for April 16.

The president in a formal statement announced that he is free to exercise at once the power to arm American merchant ships.

The proclamation for the extra session was issued at the White House this afternoon. The president said he was calling congress because so much necessary legislation was pressing for consideration.

DESERTS BABY TO PLAY POOL; WIFE ASKS A DIVORCE

Stating that she had done everything in her power to help her husband support his family but that he failed miserably, Mrs. Anna M. Mullan Saturday brought suit for legal separation before Circuit Judge Campbell against Homer M. Mullan.

Mrs. Mullan in her complaint told a story of helping her husband at farm and gardening work, of hoeing and of helping to put hay in the mow after it had been cut.

The custody of three children is asked by Mrs. Mullan in the complaint. The two were married in Milwaukee in December 1900.

According to the complaint the trouble between Mrs. Mullan and her husband reached a climax during the last presidential campaign.

The paper alleges that after Mrs. Mullan had worn herself out in the care of a sick child, she went out one evening to get some fresh air and to hear a campaign talk, leaving Mullan in charge of the child. When she returned she found the child alone and Mullan gone out to a pool hall to spend the evening.

Daly Comes Out for Mayor of Portland; Baker Holds Back

PORTLAND, Ore., March 10.—Will H. Daly, commissioner of public utilities, announced Saturday his candidacy for mayor to succeed H. R. Albee.

George L. Baker has not yet made formal announcement of his candidacy.

FATHER AND SON, IN CONGRESS, FIRST TIME IN U. S. HISTORY



SENATOR JOHN H. BANKHEAD AND SON, REPRESENTATIVE-ELECT W. B. BANKHEAD

WASHINGTON, March 15.—For the first time in the history of the United States father and son will sit in congress together, when William B. Bankhead of Alabama will take the oath of office as a member of the

house of representatives in the Sixty-fifth congress.

The father of Representative Elect Bankhead is Senator John H. Bankhead of Alabama, who has served in congress, in house and senate, for thirty years.